

6.3 IrfanView

This software, first developed in 1996, is one of the lightest photo viewing and editing software around. It occupies just 1.8 MB of system RAM with a regular image loaded—and add to that the fact that the setup file is less than 1MB, and you know it's really light.

During setup, you're asked to choose what extensions you want to associate with IrfanView. We'd recommend "images only"—meaning "all images"—unless you also want to watch video on IrfanView. Yes, it can handle video too!



IrfanView's Batch Converter is insanely useful

As with all good software, the interface is simple, with all the features nicely tucked under the respective menus. This is a feat, considering there are so many options.

"Thumbnail" under the File menu opens an Explorer-like interface which allows one to have a thumbnail preview of the files supported by IrfanView. "Select from TWAIN Source..." allows one to acquire images from



With the right plugins, IrfanView becomes a powerful all-round media player

sources like digital cameras, scanners, and TV-Tuner cards. "Acquire/Batch Scanning" not only allows one to acquire a group of images, it is also possible to rename all of them in a single go. Here, one has the option to convert the file type of the file being acquired. For example, if you've taken a photo using your digicam in RAW format and you want to convert it to JPEG, you can do so in "Acquire/Batch Scanning".